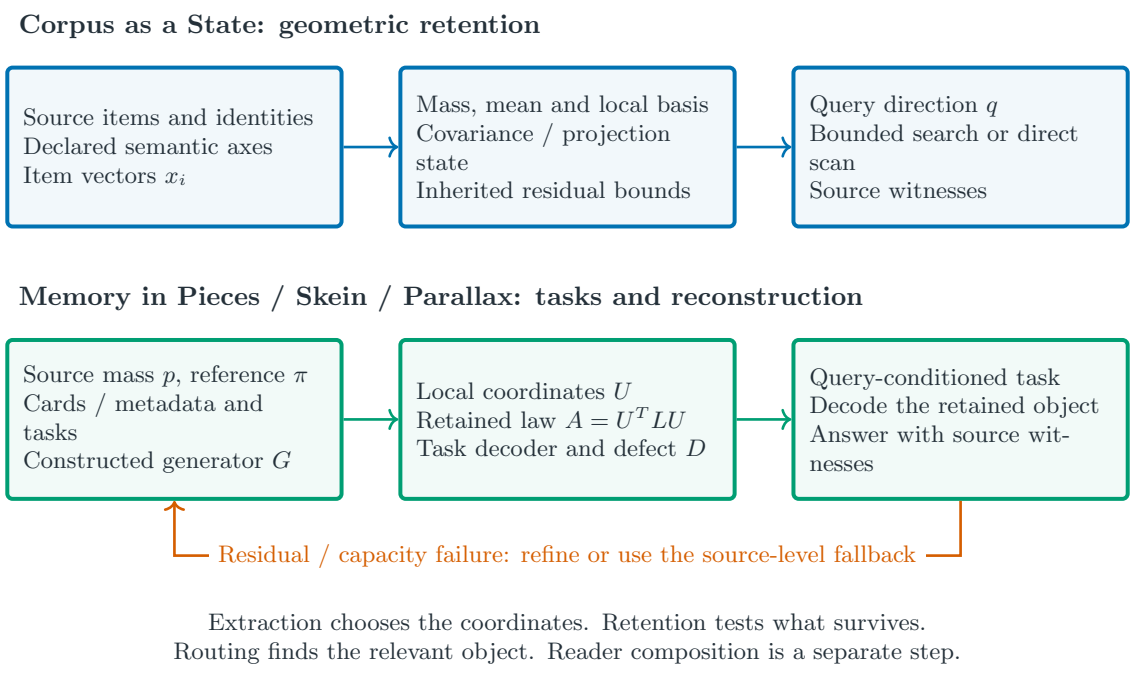
Corpus as a State: geometric retention
Source items and identities
Declared semantic axes
Item vectors x_i
Mass, mean and local basis
Covariance / projection state
Inherited residual bounds
Query direction q
Bounded search or direct scan
Source witnesses
Memory in Pieces / Skein / Parallax: tasks and reconstruction
Source mass p, reference π
Cards / metadata and tasks
Constructed generator G
Local coordinates U
Retained law $A = U^T LU$
Task decoder and defect D
Query-conditioned task
Decode the retained object
Answer with source witnesses
Residual / capacity failure: refine or use the source-level fallback
Extraction chooses the coordinates. Retention tests what survives.
Routing finds the relevant object. Reader composition is a separate step.